

Brandon Higbee

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Summary

Senior Infrastructure Engineer with **8 years** designing, building, and operating production systems at scale. At Tackle.io, owned end-to-end platform infrastructure serving **500+ enterprise customers**, driving cloud-native transformations using **AWS, Kubernetes, and Terraform**. Led migration of monolithic services to microservices, improving deployment frequency from weekly to daily releases. At Ultimate Medical Academy, built compliance-ready systems handling sensitive student data with **SOC 2** and **FERPA** requirements. Partners with cross-functional teams to deliver reliable, secure, and observable systems. Focuses on **infrastructure automation**, cost optimization, and **zero-trust security** architecture.

Core Skills

Languages and Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker, EKS, EC2, S3, VPC

CI/CD & Automation: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, ArgoCD, Helm, Ansible, scripting

Observability & Monitoring: CloudWatch, Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, logging, alerting

Security & Compliance: SOC 2, FERPA, HIPAA, zero-trust, OAuth2, IAM, encryption

Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer | Tackle.io | Remote | 03/2022 - Present

- Led migration of **monolithic services** to **Kubernetes** and **Docker** containers using **Helm** charts, improving deployment frequency from weekly to **daily releases**.
- Designed multi-region **AWS** architecture with **EKS** clusters serving **500+ enterprise customers**, reducing latency by **40%** and achieving 99.9% uptime.
- Implemented **infrastructure as code** with **Terraform** across 3 environments, reducing provisioning time from **2 hours to 15 minutes**.
- Established **zero-trust security** architecture with **OAuth2**, **IAM** roles, and network policies, achieving **SOC 2 Type II** audit readiness.
- Built comprehensive **CI/CD pipelines** with **GitHub Actions** and **ArgoCD**, enabling **5x faster** release cycles.
- Implemented **CloudWatch** and **Grafana** dashboards for **Prometheus** metrics, reducing **incident detection time by 60%**.
- Optimized cloud costs through **reserved instances** and auto-scaling policies, achieving **25% cost reduction**.
- Mentored **4 junior engineers** on **AWS** and **Kubernetes** best practices, growing team's cloud-native capabilities.

Software Engineer | Tackle.io | Remote | 06/2021 - 03/2022

- Developed and secured **RESTful APIs** with **OAuth2** and JWT authentication, reducing data breach risks for **200+ customers**.
- Built backend services in **Python** and **Go** handling **high-frequency API calls**, processing **10M+ requests daily**.
- Configured **Kubernetes** deployments with **health checks**, **resource limits**, and **pod disruption budgets**, improving reliability.
- Automated infrastructure monitoring with **Ansible** playbooks, reducing manual operational overhead by **20 hours weekly**.

Software Engineer II | Ultimate Medical Academy | Remote | 04/2019 - 06/2021

- Designed **microservices architecture** with **Java Spring Boot** and **PostgreSQL**, serving 50K+ monthly active users with 99.9% uptime.
- Built compliance-ready systems handling sensitive student data under **FERPA** and **HIPAA** requirements for **50K+ monthly users**.
- Optimized **database queries** and implemented caching layers, improving application response time from **3s to 1s**.
- Collaborated with **5+ cross-functional teams** including compliance, design, and product to deliver features on schedule.

Software Engineer I | Ultimate Medical Academy | Remote | 08/2018 - 04/2019

- Built core platform features using **Java** and **JavaScript**, improving system performance by **20%**.
- Implemented automated testing suite with **80% code coverage**, reducing production bugs by **30%**.
- Configured **CI/CD pipelines** with **Jenkins** and **Docker**, streamlining deployment workflows.

SDK Intern | Accusoft | Remote | 06/2017 - 08/2018

- Created technical documentation and sample code, improving developer onboarding efficiency for **10+ teams**.
- Developed SDK integrations and tools in **C#** and **JavaScript** for internal development teams.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of South Florida

08/2014 - 05/2018